UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.	)	Docket No. ER27-25

COMMENTS OF ALLIANT ENERGY CORPORATE SERVICES, INC. AND CONSUMERS ENERGY COMPANY IN SUPPORT OF MISO'S PROPOSED TARIFF REVISIONS

Pursuant to Rule 212 of the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission's ("FERC" or "Commission") Rules of Practice and Procedure,[1] 18 C.F.R. § 385.212, Alliant Energy Corporate Services, Inc ("AECS") and Consumers Energy Company ("Consumers Energy")[2] respectfully submit these comments in support of the Midcontinent Independent System Operator, Inc.'s ("MISO") Large Load Addition Resource Study (LARS) Proposal ("Proposal") in the above-captioned docket. AECS and its affiliates,[3] and Consumers Energy, as load-serving entities ("LSEs") support the need for an interconnection process that facilitates the timely study of generation paired with an associated large load(s) to arrive at optimized transmission solutions. Large loads increasingly seek service on accelerated timelines, creating a need for study processes capable of evaluating load, generation, and associated transmission requirements on a more coordinated basis. The LARS Proposal offers a practical approach to meeting load growth while helping to maintain resource adequacy and supporting a cost-effective mix of generating resources.

[1] 18 C.F.R. § 385.212 (2025).
[2] Consumers Energy is a Load Serving Entity (LSE) and active participant in the MISO generation interconnection queue process. Consumers Energy is a public utility serving over 1.9 million residential, commercial, and industrial electric customers in the Michigan Joint Zone of the MISO footprint.
[3] AECS affiliates include Wisconsin Power & Light Company and Interstate Power & Light Company (collectively, the "Alliant Energy Operating Companies"). The Alliant Energy Operating Companies are LSEs and active participants in the MISO generation interconnection queue process. The companies have and continue to support MISO improvements to interconnection processes and believe that while queue process enhancements are needed and helpful, the benefits will take years to realize given the current status of queue cycles.

AECS and Consumers Energy respectfully request that the Commission accept the LARS Proposal.

Support for LARS as a Just and Reasonable Study Pathway

LARS offers an opportunity to plan transmission around the combined needs of new large loads and paired generation, rather than evaluating each through separate processes. This integrated approach will enable MISO to identify optimized transmission solutions, eliminate duplicative or unnecessarily expensive upgrades, and help deliver lower-cost outcomes for customers. The LARS Proposal provides a path to avoid studying qualifying large loads and associated generation through separate processes using different assumptions and on different schedules that may produce different transmission solutions. MISO has proposed using consistent assumptions and rigorous methodologies to study the load and generation in parallel, with the objective of completing the process within approximately 120 days.[4] This approach has the potential to provide greater certainty regarding generation interconnection requirements, transmission service, and the network upgrades necessary to support reliable service. MISO's filing further explains that LARS responds directly to the Commission's Show Cause Order by allowing MISO to account for the operational dynamics of serving electrically proximate large loads.[5] These benefits support acceptance of LARS as just and reasonable.

The Commission should support reforms that allow credible, commercially mature large load projects to move forward efficiently while maintaining appropriate reliability protections. MISO's broader framework for integrating large loads onto its system appropriately recognizes that acceleration must be coupled with operational capabilities such as telemetry, coordination, curtailment capability, ride-through, stability controls, resilience, and security.

[4] LARS Proposal at 11-12, 18.
[5] *Id.* at 3.

An expedited process should be available to projects demonstrating a high degree of commercial and development certainty. MISO has emphasized that LARS is intended for specific load-generation pairings with contractual arrangements and shovel-ready conditions, rather than as an alternative fast-track interconnection queue for generators serving general system load.[6] Strong readiness requirements are therefore an appropriate safeguard against speculative projects consuming scarce study resources or affecting transmission solutions for projects that are prepared to proceed.

AECS and Consumers Energy therefore support LARS as a practical response to the planning challenges presented by new large-load development. Its value extends beyond a shorter study schedule: evaluating load and generation together creates an opportunity to optimize transmission investments and achieve lower-cost solutions for customers. By combining that opportunity with reliable study practices and clear participation safeguards, LARS provides a disciplined framework suited to the needs of the MISO footprint.

Continued Stakeholder Collaboration on Implementation

AECS and Consumers Energy expect MISO will continue working with stakeholders to refine LARS implementation details, including providing greater certainty regarding the conditions under which projects may retain interconnection rights over time. Large load development is evolving rapidly, and the industry is still gaining experience with the operating characteristics, development timelines, and transmission implications of these facilities. Accordingly, AECS and Consumers Energy support implementation of LARS with sufficient transparency and stakeholder engagement to allow MISO to refine the framework as practical experience identifies opportunities for improvement. Continued stakeholder engagement will be

[6] *Id.* at 11, 25, and 28.

important to realizing the benefits of LARS while maintaining reliable service and the integrity of the interconnection process.

For these reasons, AECS and Consumers Energy respectfully request that the Commission find MISO's LARS Proposal is a just and reasonable approach to coordinating the study of large loads and paired generation, optimizing transmission solutions, and facilitating timely, reliable service at lower costs for customers, and accept the LARS Proposal.

Respectfully submitted,

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CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I hereby certify I have this day served the foregoing document upon each person designated on the official service list compiled by the Secretary in these proceedings.

Dated at Cedar Rapids, Iowa, this 23 day of October 2026.

/s/ Dezirae Fisher

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